SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #60 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

"I can't trust anybody."

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Where it often comes from

Betrayal by a parent, spouse, friend, church leader, or institution can convince us that everyone will eventually hurt us. We keep people at arm's length. Safe, but alone.

What Scripture teaches

"Cursed is the man who trusts in mankind... But blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, whose confidence is in Him." "It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man." Yet Scripture also shows trustworthy people: "Two are better than one," and "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another." Jesus told His disciples, "be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves." Trust is not all or nothing. It can be given in small steps, to people who show themselves reliable, while our deepest trust rests in God.

> *"It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man"* (Psalm 118:8).

Also see

> "This is what the LORD says: 'Cursed is the man who trusts in mankind, who makes the flesh his strength and turns his heart from the LORD. He will be like a shrub in the desert; he will not see when prosperity comes. He will dwell in the parched places of the desert, in a salt land where no one lives. But blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, whose confidence is in Him.'" (Jeremiah 17:5–7).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another" (Proverbs 27:17).

> "Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves" (Matthew 10:16).

Common self-statements

- Everyone lets me down.
- If I trust, I will be hurt.
- People cannot be relied on.
- I am safer alone.
- I will never open up again.
- They all have an agenda.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people are either fully trustworthy or not at all.
- Mind reading: Assuming betrayal.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hurt and concluding that no one is safe.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will be hurt again.

Challenging questions

- Who betrayed my trust, and what happened?

- Has anyone proven reliable, even in small ways?
- What would trust in small steps look like?
- What do I lose by trusting no one?
- What does Scripture say about trusting God and people?
- Who could help me heal from the betrayal?

Truth summary

> Some people hurt me, but not everyone will. My deepest trust belongs to God, who never fails, and I can give trust slowly to those who prove reliable. Healing makes room for safe relationships.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Forgiveness
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't trust anybody"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't trust anybody." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who betrayed me?
- ☐ Who is reliable?
- ☐ What small step?
- ☐ What do I lose?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Who can help me heal?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Taking refuge in the Lord is better.
- ☐ God never fails.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Trust can be given in small steps.
- ☐ Not everyone will hurt me.
- ☐ Healing is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 118:8**
  "It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10**
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ **Proverbs 27:17**
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Small steps of trust: Each week, note one small trust you tried and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 118:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "It is better to take refuge in the Lord than to trust in man.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the betrayal. Write what happened and how it affected you.
- [ ] List reliable people. Note anyone who has proven trustworthy.
- [ ] Try a small trust. Share something small and watch the response.
- [ ] Seek healing. Consider counseling for betrayal wounds.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't trust anybody": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small steps of trust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't trust anybody.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was hurt, and trusting is hard. You never fail. Heal my heart, give me discernment, and bring safe people into my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.